

APP ECOSYSTEM



Digitus Primus

No, this is not the scientific name of a Digit reading primate. Evolution is a long drawn out process taking millions and millions of years. One thing we didn't realise



though, at the time we stepped down from the trees was that, the "Digitus Primus" has been one of the greatest gifts to mankind ever. Of course it wasn't much used, though your sixth grade biology books would beg to differ. With the advent of the mobile phone however, these have really come of age, with apps and entire interfaces being designed around them. For those of you who haven't figured it out yet, we're talking about thumbs!



PhoneGap

Consider this situation, you so very badly want to buy a phone made by X. X-Phone looks lovely, has a gorgeous UI and the camera of your dreams, however, you also have the very decent Phone Y running on a more popular platform and hosting the app of your dreams. Something to improve your productivity no end, *Angry Birds*, whatever. If it wasn't for apps like PhoneGap, which bridge the "gap" between various platforms by providing a consistent platform to host your app, you would be left with bland looking Y simply because your app won't run on the gorgeous X!



N-gage

There are few among us who had the pleasure of owning and playing on the N-gage devices from Nokia. The device was way ahead of its time and boasted of some of the best 3d games of its era. Originally meant to be a direct competitor to Nintendo's GameBoy device, the N-gage just couldn't keep up due to the



lack of games and being an expensive device. Nokia didn't give up hope however and continued to develop N-gage as a platform before releasing it as a service in 2005, on the N-81. This service was again not well-received and Nokia had to finally discontinue the service completely in 2008.



Rovio

Who would have thought that hurling screeching birds at starving pigs' heads holding out behind flimsy wood, stone and glass structures would turn out to become one of the most popular mobile games ever? Rovio certainly didn't. *Angry Birds* is currently the most popular mobile game and boasts of over 500 million downloads to date. You really must feel for the poor, suffering pigs though. How would you feel if you were just about to boil an egg and you suddenly saw a black bird hurtling toward you while screaming insane invective, only to turn red and blow up at your feet in a puff of black feathers? An unnerving experience for sure.



Gameloft

A French game developer, Gameloft is almost synonymous with the mobile gaming scene. Owned by the Guillemot brothers, the owners and founders of Ubisoft, the company has always enjoyed exclusive rights to some of the biggest games on the PC and console platforms. The company's products have won many awards including "game of the year" for *Assassin's Creed* in 2008. The company is also famous for its "Asphalt" racing games.



Zomato

While most people would be running around looking for lost menu cards when they were hungry, Deepinder Goyal decided to actually deal with the problem instead of fluttering about, and, started off by creating a way to manage and digitise the piles of restaurant menus that he and his friends used. The result was Zomato. The web app now covers over 2000 restaurants in Delhi, Kolkatta, Mumbai, Pune and Bangalore, with plans to expand further.



Snake

That ever-growing, gluttonous creature that only gets faster with time. Snake is to mobile gaming what *Doom* was to the PC. The game was a staple feature on almost all Nokia devices for almost a decade and is the most popular mobile game on the planet. For a game that started out as a students' exercise in BASIC, this is quite an achievement. Now though, despite being such a good game, Snake is dying out. Nokia still retains the copyright to the 3D version of the game (by far the best version) and has no plans to release a remake in the foreseeable future. A sad day indeed for mobile gaming.




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The amount of money, that Apple makes solely on the sale of apps from the iTunes App store. The store has grown in popularity so much that now an average of ten million apps are downloaded daily. With developers numbering in the hundreds of thousands, the sheer number of apps available has hit record heights as well.